

Module Overview

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This module is meant to engage us in a multifaceted exploration of identity, skills, intellect, and criticality within educational spaces. Through critical self-reflection, we will examine how personal language, cultural background, and lived experiences shape both our own identities and our pedagogical approaches. Through this process we will develop intellectual depth connecting theoretical frameworks—such as intersectionality, culturally sustaining pedagogy, and critical literacy—to real-world classroom practices. By refining our approach to skills, we will design identity-affirming and inclusive lesson plans that integrate historically and culturally responsive teaching methods. Finally, through criticality, we will interrogate how power, privilege, and systemic inequities influence language and learning, while exploring ways to disrupt traditional narratives and advocate for more just and humanizing educational spaces. This module bridges theory and practice and will be challenging. I am asking you to think deeply, reflect critically, and apply your learning to foster equitable and empowering literacy instruction.

Module Objectives

1. We will critically reflect on personal language and identity. We will engage in self-reflection to examine how personal language, cultural background, and lived experiences shape identity and influence perspectives on teaching and learning.
2. We will analyze the intersection of identity, power, and language in education. We will apply theoretical frameworks, such as intersectionality and culturally sustaining pedagogy, to analyze how identity, language, and power dynamics shape students' learning experiences in the classroom.
3. We will synthesize personal insights with theoretical perspectives. We will connect personal language and identity experiences to key academic texts, demonstrating the ability to synthesize theory with lived experiences to develop a deeper understanding of identity in education.
4. We will develop Identity-Affirming and Inclusive Teaching Practices. We will design lesson plans or realistic learning activities that integrate students' diverse identities, emphasizing Gholdy Muhammad's five pursuits—Joy, Identity, Skills, Intellect, and Criticality—to foster equity and representation in classroom instruction.
5. We will apply a pedagogy of love to literacy and identity development. We will explore how a pedagogy of love and relational teaching practices can create affirming, student-centered learning environments that validate and uplift our students' linguistic and cultural identities.

Module Assignments:

- Read all readings & engage with all Digital Resources (organized by week above)
- Engage in Synchronous Zoom Class 7
- Harmonize Discussion Board B Class 7 Readings
- Engage in Synchronous Zoom Class 8
- Harmonize Discussion Board A Class 8 Readings
- Post-Mini-Unit Ideas in Asynchronous assignment

- Engage in **Synchronous** Zoom (subject to change to Asynchronous class/ Predominately Asynchronous Class) Class week 9
- Harmonize Discussion Board B Class 9 Readings
- Engage in **Asynchronous** Class 10 work
- Submit Literacy as Power Bridging Social Justice and Critical Communication